

Dear Members of the Michigan City Common Council,

I am writing to express my opposition to the proposed expansion of Flock Safety technology in Michigan City.

But I believe the discussion should go beyond whether the City should spend an additional \$300,000 on this proposal. There are broader questions about oversight, the existing Flock relationship, and the timing of this expenditure that deserve public discussion before any expansion moves forward.

First, why are surveillance safeguards being considered as part of a proposal involving one particular vendor?

Rules governing surveillance technology should protect Michigan City residents regardless of which company provides the technology. Those protections should not end simply because a contract ends or a different vendor is selected. I ask the Council to consider a separate surveillance technology ordinance establishing clear, lasting rules for access, retention, sharing, auditing, oversight, and accountability.

Second, why are we discussing expanding Flock before publicly examining the City's existing relationship with Flock?

Before adding more technology or committing additional public money, I believe the Council should publicly examine the existing agreement, determine when it renews, review the City's options, and debate whether continuing that agreement remains in the community's best interest.

I believe the City should allow the current Flock agreement to expire rather than renew it. I implore the Council to bring that question before the public for a full discussion before approving an expansion of the technology.

Finally, why does this expansion need to happen now?

An additional \$300,000 is a significant public expenditure. Every public dollar committed here is a dollar that cannot be used for another community priority. I ask the Council to consider whether this proposal should instead be evaluated through the normal budget process, alongside the City's other needs and priorities.

Before Michigan City expands this technology, please give the community an opportunity to publicly consider the more fundamental question: **Should we continue what we already have?**

Thank you for your consideration.

Name: _____

Address: _____

Ward, if known: _____